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Business Concept

The Late Knight Café is a late-night, student-centered space offering cozy study zones, social areas, and delicious pastries—creating a safe, inclusive environment that fosters focus, creativity, and community.

Student-focused space:

- Cozy study zones with charging stations
- Quiet areas for focus & productivity
- Flexible setup for solo or group work

Inclusivity & Social Connection:

- All students welcome
- Builds campus community
- Open mic nights & creative events

Late-Night Convenience:

- Open past campus dining hall hours
- Quick pastries & Specialty drinks
- Perfect for late-night studying or hangouts

Hybrid Wellness Space:

- Study zone vs. social zone
- Calm stress-free environment
- Wellness events- therapy dogs, yoga, etc.

Customer Value Proposition

- ❑ Late Knight Cafe is one of the only cozy spots to grab a drink or snack late at night
- ❑ Late Knight Cafe caters to any scenario, with a mix of both:
 - ❑ Group seating for a comfy social setting
 - ❑ Quiet, isolated seating for focusing on work
- ❑ Late Knight Cafe is equipped with charging stations and free wifi for customers to enjoy during their stay



Core Values, Vision & Mission Statement

Vision Statement

Brewing connections and comfort, one cup at a time.

Core Values

- Accessibility - Open late hours
- Community - Social relations
- Cleanliness - Nice environment
- Affordability - Student pricing

Mission Statement

Late Knight Cafe exists to provide students with a safe, affordable, and welcoming late-night environment that combines quality pastries and drinks, quiet study zones with sleep pods, and social spaces. We aim to support academic success, personal well-being, and campus community by offering extended hours, mindfulness programs, and engaging events that enrich the student experience.

Financial and Strategic Objectives

Financial:

1. Achieve break-even within the first 12 months
 - a. Reach **AT LEAST \$25,000**
2. Increase net profit margin to **10%** of gross sales by end of Year 1
 - a. Cost Controls
 - b. Efficient Supply Sourcing
3. **Reduce** food and beverage cost by **5%**

Strategic:

1. Grow social media page to **AT LEAST 1,000** followers & **AT LEAST 15%** repeat customers
 - a. Promoting
 - b. Offers
 - c. Loyalty incentives
2. Returning customer rate of **40%** by end of Year 2
 - a. Loyalty Programs
 - b. Study-night specials
3. Host **1** wellness/creative event **per week**

Corporate Social Responsibility



Sustainability

- Eco-friendly cups
- Reduce food waste
- Donating surplus to local shelters



Community & Inclusivity

- Yoga Nights
- Open Mics
- Meditation
- Welcoming Everyone



Employee Health

- Fair Treatment
- Adequate Compensation
- Flexible hours
- Employee Discounts

Description of New Product/Service

Late Knight Delivery Service:

The service delivers food and drinks to the dorms and surrounding apartments late at night. It serves the needs of our students for convenience and safety late in the evening while also increasing sales.

Study Snack Boxes:

Pre-packaged, affordable healthy snack kits for long study blocks (like energy bars, fruit, and drinks). These may be purchased in-store or online and provide additional sales revenue and brand positioning.

Membership & Rewards Program:

A monthly membership option for discounts, early access to events, and free coffee refills. It encourages students to return for repeat business and build a sense of student community.

National Expansion Decision, Approach, Rationale

National Expansion?

YES

Approach

Build brand recognition and credibility for universities.

Expansion of revenue & profit through new student markets.

Encourages university partnerships and supplier partnerships.

Increases job opportunity for students nationwide.

Rationale

Late Knight Café delivers a successful concept to solve student health/wellness, study space, and value. Expanding nationally will enhance its brand and also promote community amongst college students. Given good management and a scalable business model, Late Knight Café should easily expand in a responsible way while maintain its quality across all stores.

Global Expansion: United Kingdom

Opportunities

- Similar values to the United States
- High demand for student spaces
- Multicultural market
 - Diverse population
- Prestigious & famous universities
 - Oxford, Cambridge, etc.

Challenges

- Overseas
 - Far from original location
- Fewer universities and college towns
- Seasonal demand fluctuations
 - Cold winters drive down foot traffic
- Currency exchange rates
- Slightly different labor and food service regulations

Overall Rationale

The United Kingdom's vibrant café culture and abundance of top universities make it an ideal market for Late Knight Café's expansion, offering strong demand for social, study-friendly coffee spaces despite the challenges of moving overseas.

Expansion Strategy

Customization allows Late Knight Cafe to meet UK cultural preferences and regulatory requirements while building stronger local connections & customer loyalty.

Entry Strategy

Joint Venture Entry Strategy

It balances protecting Late Knight Café's unique Rutgers Scarlet Knights identity with the benefit of having a global partner to navigate local regulations, labor markets, and promotional strategies near universities.

Key Job Criteria

Key Job: Barista

Criteria: A hire who **fulfills all qualifications** and is readily available to work

Responsibilities:

- ☐ **Efficiently** prepare drinks and food orders for customers
- ☐ Confident in preparing **seasonal beverages** or other custom orders
- ☐ **Manage** drink stations and **clean** tables, floors, counters, and restrooms

Compensation Plan:

- ☐ **Hourly Rate:** **\$16.50/hour**
- ☐ **Incentives:** **Free** beverage/meal during shift, flexible scheduling, employee recognition rewards, sick and vacation days

Qualifications:

- ☐ **Excellent** customer service
- ☐ Able to work **late hours**
- ☐ Able to **multitask**

Advertising Plan:

- ☐ Rutgers **student employee portal**
- ☐ **Indeed.com**
- ☐ Campus bulletin boards

Employee Motivation Initiatives

Initiatives	Summary
Employee Recognition Program	Create a “Knight of the Month” program, recognizing exceptional work by employees and distributing rewards such as monetary bonuses or meal vouchers
Career Growth Incentives	(Baristas -> Managers) Employees are offered opportunities for advancement , potentially rising to management roles as they gain experience and show effort
Wellness and Break Support	Employees are given frequent 15-minute breaks . During exam weeks, cafe management will be very understanding towards employees and offer relief compensation wherever they can
Team Building Events	Monthly café events, game nights, coffee tasting, or staff dinners to improve relationships and communication between staff members.

Informing employees

Dear Late Knight Café Team,

I hope you are all doing well. I wanted to inform you that two of our team members decided to leave Late Knight Café. We are sad to see them go, but we respect their choices and wish them the best in their next steps.

After reflecting on this, we realized it is a good time to enhance our support and motivation for our wonderful team. Starting this month, we will be implementing a few new initiatives:

- **Recognition Program:** “Knight of the Month” to recognize your amazing work
- **Flexible Scheduling:** More freedom to request or change shifts
- **Team Events:** Monthly café hangouts
- **Wellness Perks:** Free drinks during shifts and increased employee discounts

Our goal is to make Late Knight Café not just a workplace, but a fun, supportive and motivating environment for everyone. Your feedback is also welcome as we roll these out.

Warm regards,
Your Management Team

Employee Engagement

Description: Levels of emotional and mental attachment employees have to their job, colleagues, and the company.

Recognition Program

- “Knight of the Month”
- Recognizing employees
- Prizes, Meal vouchers, small monetary bonuses
- Encouragement

Wellness & Breaks

- 10-15 Mins for stretching or relaxation
- Decompressing
- Employees will get free drinks and snacks during exam periods

Career Growth

- Baristas → Managers
- Opportunities for advancement
- Gain experience and new skills

Team-Building

- Monthly cafe events
- Game nights
- Coffee tasting
- Staff dinners

IDEAL EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

Connection 8/10



Satisfaction 7/10



Purpose and Meaning 9/10



SIPOC for Key Process

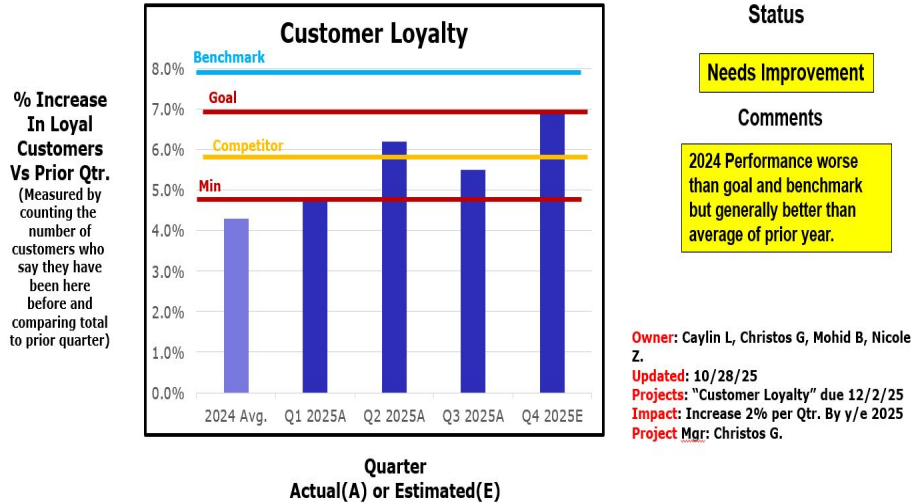
RUTGERS

Rutgers Business School
Newark and New Brunswick

Suppliers	Inputs	Processes	Outputs	Customers
• Rutgers University • Local Coffee Roasters • International Coffee Roasters • Pastry Vendors • Student Employees • IT Maintenance staff • Silverware, plates, cups vendors	• Coffee Beans • Milk • Pastries • Cups • Cafe POS system • Wifi • Student labor • Marketing materials	• Greet customer • Create Menu (drinks, snacks, pastries, seasonal specials) • Take order & process payment • Prepare beverages/food • Serve order • Maintain cleanliness & seating space	• Coffee • Affordable drinks & pastries • Prepared Food • Social Media Page (Instagram, Facebook, etc) • Website • Dirty cups and dishes, tables • Garbage (Plastic cups, napkins) • Food leftovers, crumbs • Mindfulness programming (yoga, therapy dogs, etc.)	• Rutgers students, faculty, local community • Behaviors: repeat visits, word-of-mouth referrals, etc. • Customer requirements: affordable food/drinks, wellness resources, extended hours

Effectiveness Measurement vs. Efficiency Measurement

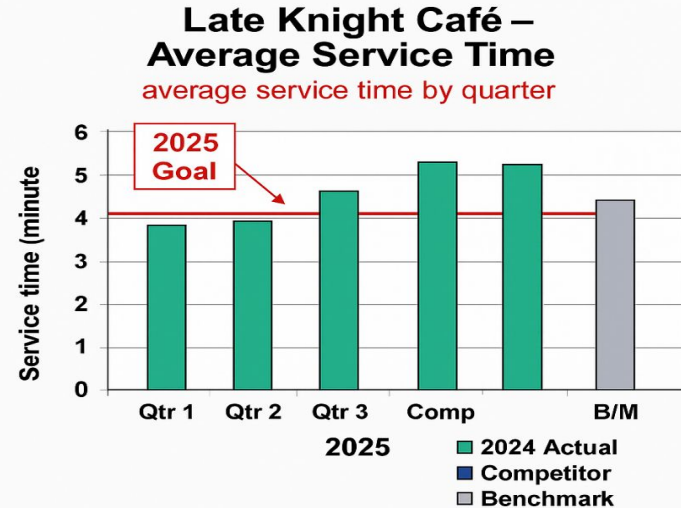
Well-Dressed Measure – LateKnight Cafe



Effectiveness (Customer Loyalty)

- Goal: Increase returning customers
- Trend: Improving each quarter

Efficiency Measure (WDM)



Efficiency (Cost / Service Time)

- Goal: Lower cost per drink
- Trend: Costs decreasing

Key Initiative to Improve Process

Improvement Initiative: **Student Rewards Program**

Rationale:

Customers earn points for each drink purchased

- e.g., "Buy 9 drinks, get the 10th free"
- Promote the program using campus social media and through in-store signage. This creates a **reason** for the customer to **return** more regularly and increases **loyalty** and emotional **connection** to the café.

Team Decision

**Sell the
Business?**

NO

Rationale:

This sale boosts short-term shareholder profit but **harms** all other stakeholders. Selling to unqualified owners for “fun” **betrays** employees, customers, and the brand’s culture. Long-term value lies in responsible growth, not quick cash. We can restructure and expand ethically without selling out. Rejecting this offer protects our people, legacy, and brand integrity, true sustainable management.

Why Business Has Been Successful

- **Clear Understanding of Student Needs**
 - Addresses students' lifestyles and needs
 - Extended hours and relaxes study environments
- **Unique Concepts and Atmosphere**
 - Cafe + Study Lounges
 - Wellness pods, quiet zones, events
- **Strong Brand Identity**
 - Using Scarlet red colors and pride
 - A mission built around community, wellness, and productivity
- **Consistent Quality and Innovation**
 - Maintaining high quality drinks, seasonal special and friendly services
 - New items keeping customers curious and loyal
- **Collaboration and Inclusivity**
 - Collaboration with Rutgers Clubs, student artist
 - A cafe where ideas, friendships, and creativity thrive